L-P-325B
June 8, 1973
SUPERSEDING
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July 3, 1967

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PITCHERS AND SERVERS, PLASTIC, INSULATED

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers requirements for insulated plastic pitchers and servers with detachable hinged lids for office and hospital use.

1.2 Classification. Pitchers and servers shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Pitcher, 32-ounce.

Type II - Server, 10-ounce.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

L-P-390 - Plastic, Molding and Extrusion Material, Polyethylene and Copolymers (Low, Medium, and High Density).
L-P-394 - Plastic Molding Material, (Propylene Plastics, Injection and Extrusion).
L-P-398 - Plastic Molding Material, Styrene-Butadiene.
L-P-399 - Plastic Molding and Extrusion Material, Styrene-acrylonitrile Copolymers.
L-P-1183 - Plastic Molding Material, Acrylonitrile-Butadiene-Styrene (ABS), Rigid.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-M-14 - Molding Plastics and Molded Plastic Parts, Thermosetting.

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations:

21 CFR 121:

Subpart F - Food Additives Resulting From Contact With Containers or Equipment and Food Additives Otherwise Affecting Food.

(The Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) and the Federal Register (FR) are for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. When indicated, reprints of certain regulations may be obtained from the Federal agency responsible for issuance thereof.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample. When specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced, a sample of the insulated pitcher or server shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for approval in accordance with 4.2. The approval of the preproduction sample authorizes the commencement of production, but does not relieve the supplier of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The preproduction sample shall be manufactured in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

3.2 Standard product. The pitchers and servers delivered under this specification shall be the manufacturer's commercially current standard product, except for modifications which are required to meet specific requirements of this specification.

3.3 Materials. Materials specified shall conform to the applicable specifications and requirements specified hereinafter. Where materials are not definitely specified, they shall be of the quality used for the purpose in commercial practice.

3.3.1 Compliance. The supplier shall present either a certificate or satisfactory evidence that the materials used in the finished product comply with the requirements of 3.3.2 and 3.3.3.

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3.3.2 Plastic. Plastic material specified hereinafter shall be virgin material; however, reground imperfect parts, sprues, and runners due to molding, or forming imperfections of the same composition as the virgin material shall be acceptable. Plastic materials shall conform to subpart F of 21 CFR 121.

3.3.2.1 Polyethylene, high density. High density polyethylene shall be a linear type conforming to L-P-390, type I, class H, grade 1.

3.3.2.2 Polyethylene, low density. Low density polyethylene shall conform to L-P-390, type I, class L, grade 2.

3.3.2.3 Polypropylene. Polypropylene shall conform to L-P-394, type III, grade A.

3.3.2.4 Styrene-butadiene. Styrene-butadiene shall conform to L-P-398, type II, class 2.

3.3.2.5 Acrylonitrile-butadiene-styrene. Acrylonitrile-butadiene-styrene (ABS) shall conform to L-P-1183, type I.

3.3.2.6 Phenolic. Phenolic heat-resistant molding plastic shall conform to type MFH of MIL-M-14, except that reground scrap shall not be used and the electrical tests are not required.

3.3.2.7 Styrene-acrylonitrile. Styrene-acrylonitrile shall conform to L-P-399.

3.3.3 Insulation. Insulating material shall be a nonabsorbent, non-settling type.

3.4 Design. The pitcher and server in figure 1 are illustrative only, and are not intended to preclude any commercial design otherwise conforming to the requirements specified herein.

3.5 Construction. The pitchers and servers shall have inner and outer shells of plastic material conforming to 3.3.2 joined to form insulating space between shells. The insulating space shall contain insulating material conforming to 3.3.3. The outer and inner shells shall be sealed to prevent the entrance of moisture, food, or cleaning solution. Test for compliance in accordance with 4.5.4. After completion of test specified in 4.5.4, the increase of pitcher and server weight including lids shall be less than 5 percent. Where the two shells are joined by solvent cement, and vapor may be trapped, the assembly shall be vented and such vapor purged before sealing. All plastic cemented or bonded together shall be of similar material to provide maximum joint strength.

3.5.1 Lid. The lid for the pitcher and the server shall be hinged and shall be capable of being removed, securely replaced to the body, and able to support its weight in the open position when tested in accordance with 4.5.4.

3.5.2 Handle. The handle of the pitcher and the server shall be molded as an integral part of the body or molded separately and permanently attached to the body. Handle shall be located diametrically opposite the center of the pouring spout. Handle shall be either a closed or open type at the option of the manufacturer.

3.6 Color. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), any color shall be acceptable, except the exterior surface shall not be predominately black in color.

3.7 Finish. The surface throughout the pitchers and servers shall have a uniformly high luster produced by molding and no appreciable change of surface luster shall be evident when tested as specified in 4.5.4. No surface shall be painted or otherwise treated with a protective coating or adulterant. No machining of surfaces shall be permitted except for removal of flash at dividing line of mold.

3.8 Performance. Minimum performance for the type I pitcher and the type II server as determined for end use requirements shall be as specified in 3.8.1 and 3.8.2, as applicable, and 3.8.3.

3.8.1 Type I pitcher, 32-ounce minimum capacity.

Heat Endurance (see 4.5.1), 3 hours.
Cold Endurance (see 4.5.2), 9 hours.
Ice Cubes used (see 4.5.2), 8 cubes.
Drop Test (see 4.5.3), 16 inches from bottom.

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3.8.2 Type II Server, 10-ounce minimum capacity.

Heat Endurance (see 4.5.1), 1-1/2 hours.
Cold Endurance (see 4.5.2), 4 hours.
Ice Cubes used (see 4.5.2), 2 cubes.
Drop Test (see 4.5.3), 16 inches from bottom.

3.8.3 Thermal and shock testing.

3.8.3.1 Thermal test. No cracking or breakage of the inner liner shall be evidenced after testing in accordance with 4.5.5.1.

3.8.3.2 Shock test. No cracking or breakage of the inner liner shall be acceptable for drops from 6 inches above the lid opening after testing in accordance with 4.5.5.2.

3.9 Caution marking. Each pitcher and server shall be permanently marked with a caution to the effect that maximum dishwashing water temperature shall not exceed 180°F. Exact phraseology to be used and location of marking shall be at the discretion of the manufacturer

3.10 Marking for identification. Each pitcher and server shall be permanently and distinctly marked on the exterior bottom surface with the manufacturer's name, or trademark of such known character as to be easily identifiable with the manufacturer.

3.11 Workmanship. The finished pitchers and servers shall have rounded edges and shall be clean and well made.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. Where a certificate of compliance is submitted (see 3.3.1), the Government reserves the right to check-test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Preproduction sample. Inspection and testing of the preproduction sample shall be made on a completely fabricated item for all applicable provisions of this specification.

4.3 Sampling.

4.3.1 Lot. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a lot shall consist of all pitchers and servers of one type submitted for inspection at the same time.

4.3.2 Visual examination of end item. Sampling for this examination shall be in accordance with level S-3 in MIL-STD-105. The acceptable quality levels (AQL's) for defects listed in table I shall be 2.5 percent defective for major defects and 6.5 percent defective for total defects.

4.3.3 Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be in accordance with level S-3 in MIL-STD-105. AQL for tests shall be 2.5 percent defective. Samples shall be selected at random from at least five different cartons from each lot and shall be tested in accordance with 4.5.

4.4 Examination.

4.4.1 End item. Pitchers and servers selected in accordance with 4.3.2 shall be examined for defects listed in table I.

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TABLE I. Classification of defects, end item

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Pitchers and Servers	Scuffed or abraded area	X	
	Scratch		X
	Dent	X	
	Crack or fracture	X	
	Chalking	X	
	Pinhole	X	
	Blister	X	
	Wrinkle	X	
	Pit	X	
	Flow mark	X	
	Shrinkage	X	
	Unfilled area	X	
	Chipped	X	
	Presence of mechanical oil, grease, dirt, wood shaving, metal chips, or other foreign matter		X
	Checked	X	
Luster	Lacks Luster (dull)	X	
	Not uniform high luster throughout.		X
Corners and edges	Sharp	X	
	Not "broken" and polished		X
Surfaces and curves	Not blended smoothly		X
Flashline	Not machined or burnished		X
	Insufficiently ground and burnished		X
Handle	Missing	X	
	Not as specified	X	
	Improperly attached	X	
Identification marking	Missing, incomplete, illegible, incorrect		X

4.4.2 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packing, packaging, and marking requirements comply with section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of interior packaging, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery selected just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of container.

4.5 Tests. Determination of water temperatures for tests in 4.5.1 and 4.5.2 shall be made by inserting an immersible thermometer with the sensing bulb placed in the center of the liquid level.

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4.5.1 Heat endurance. Fill pitcher or server with boiling water and allow to stand 5 minutes, plus or minus 1 minute. Refill sample to within 1/4 inch of bottom of lid with boiling water. Maintain ambient air temperature at 70°F., plus or minus 2°F. Start test when temperature of water has reached 200°F., plus or minus 2°F. Record starting time and allow the sample, with lid closed, to remain for applicable length of time specified in 3.8. Check water temperature in sample. A decrease below 140°F. constitutes failure of the test.

4.5.2 Cold endurance. Fill pitcher or server with ice water and sufficient ice cubes to precool the sample to 10 minutes, plus or minus 2 minutes, at a water temperature of 35°F. or under. Maintain ambient air temperature at 70°F., plus or minus 2°F. Empty sample of water and cubes, and immediately insert required number of ice cubes specified in 3.8. Use solid prefrozen cubes measuring a minimum of 1-3/8 inches per side. Fill sample with prechilled water at 35°F., plus or minus 1°F., to within 1/4 inch of bottom of lid. Close lid on sample, record starting time, and allow for an elapse of the applicable time specified in 3.8. Check water temperature in sample. An increase above 45°F. constitutes failure of the test.

4.5.3 Drop test. Fill the pitcher or server with water within 1/4 inch of bottom of lid. Secure lid and adjacent area with masking tape to prevent splattering of water. By means of a cord suspend the sample so that on release, contact will be made on the bottom end. This may be done by tying the cord to the top of the carrying handle of the sample. Cut string and allow to fall by gravity to hit on hard surfaced floor. This drop provides maximum severity. Examine sample for damage. Small chips or fractures are permitted providing the inner container wall is in nowise impared. Determination that sample is not still completely serviceable constitutes failure of the test.

4.5.4 Dishwasher test. Determine the suitablity of pitchers and servers by cycling them through a commercial dishwasher for at least 25 wash and rinse cycles (see 3.5). One cycle is defined as one wash and rinse cycle. Use a commercial spray type dishwasher bearing the National Sanitation Foundation (NSF) seal of approval. Allow the pitchers and servers to air cool at room temperature between complete cycles. Use a wash cycle water temperature range of 150°F-160°F. and a rinse cycle water temeprature range of 175°F-180°F. Remove lids before each wash cycle and replace lids after the corresponding rinse cycle to determine compliance with 3.5.1. Before commencing the dishwasher test, weigh all pitchers and servers including lids. After completion of 25 dishwasher cycles, reweigh all pitchers and servers including lids. Calculate the increase of weight as follows:

$$\text{Percent increase of weight} = \frac{W_2 - W_1}{W_1} \times 100$$

Where:

W2 = weight of pitcher or server after 25 cycles.
W1 = weight of pitcher or server before 25 cycles.

The percent increase of weight shall conform to 3.5. The pitchers and servers shall also conform to 3.7.

4.5.5 Thermal and shock test.

4.5.5.1 Thermal. Fill pitcher and server with chilled ice water and allow to stand for 10 minutes. Empty and fill with boiling water and allow to stand for 10 minutes. Repeat test for 6 cycles to determine suitability (see 3.8 and 3.8.3.1).

4.5.5.2 Shock. Test for breakage of inner liner by dropping full sized ice cubes into empty pitcher and server (see 3.8 and 3.8.3.2).

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each pitcher or server shall be individually wrapped and cushioned in cellulosic cushioning material conforming to PPP-C-843 and packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, W5C minimum. Closure of boxes shall be in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

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5.1.2 Level B. Level B packaging shall be in accordance with 5.1.1, except that the fiberboard box shall be PPP-B-636, class domestic and the boxes shall be closed in accordance with method II of the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.1.3 Level C. The pitchers or servers shall be packaged to insure protection during shipment and safe delivery to destination.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Twenty-four (24) pitchers or servers shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Style of the box shall be optional except that OPF and FPF shall not be used. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twenty-four (24) pitchers or servers shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Style of the box shall be optional except that OPF and FPF shall not be used. Closure shall be in accordance with method II of the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The pitchers and servers shall be packed to insure protection during shipment and safe delivery to destination in compliance with the National Motor Freight Classification rules or the Uniform Freight Classification rules, as applicable.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2, as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. All marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. All marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

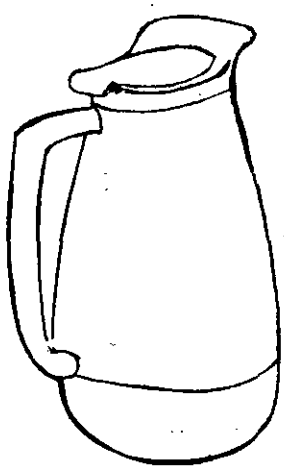
6.1 Intended use. Pitchers and servers covered by this specification are intended for use in offices and hospitals or wherever a hot or cold storage container of limited duration is desired, and where the requirement is not for glass lined vacuum containers.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type required (see 1.2).
(c) When a preproduction sample is required (see 3.1).
(d) Special color required (see 3.6).
(e) Size of lot, if different from 4.3.1.
(f) Required levels of packing and packaging (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(g) Marking required (see 5.3).

6.3 Deletion data. Classes and sizes (see 1.2) have been deleted from this specification.

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Type I - Pitcher



Type II - Server

FIGURE 1. Pitchers and servers

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

GSA-FSS
VA-DMS

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